

Raffaele "Raf" Vitale

Staff Product Designer / Design Engineer (AI & Platforms)

Toronto, Canada | London, UK (relocating 2026)

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Summary

Staff (L6) Product Designer and Design Engineer operating at the intersection of AI systems, developer platforms, and large-scale product surfaces. Proven ability to own ambiguous 0→1 initiatives, define interaction models for emerging technologies, and ship trusted, scalable systems through close partnership with engineering and leadership.

Experience

Walmart Global, Walmart Seller

Staff UX Designer – Marketplace & Seller Systems | 2025 – Present

Designing seller-facing systems supporting pricing, inventory, and growth recommendations at marketplace scale.

- Leading UX for SuccessHub, consolidating multiple recommendation surfaces into a single decision-making experience
 - Simplifying multi-step recommendation acceptance flows across mobile and web to reduce friction and increase adoption
 - Partnering with product, engineering, and data teams to improve clarity, trust, and effectiveness of automated recommendations
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Obvious.ai

AI Product Designer – AI Systems | Q4 2025

Designing AI-native product experiences centred on skills, workflows, and agent-based systems.

- Shaping interaction models for LLM-powered outputs with emphasis on trust, controllability, and user understanding

- Prototyping and validating UX patterns for human–AI collaboration loops in high-ambiguity domains
 - Working closely with Jon Bell and engineers to translate emerging AI capabilities into product surfaces for Q1 2026 launch
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Coinbase – Developer Platform

Senior Product Designer – Developer Tools (Contract) | Q3 2025

Designed developer-facing tooling for querying indexed blockchain data using SQL-based workflows.

- Reduced cognitive load and setup friction through developer interviews and task-focused UX design
 - Contributed to Pay with USDC explorations and supporting platform surfaces, prioritizing clarity and trust in financial interactions
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Voiceflow

Senior Product Designer – AI Agents | Q1-Q2 2025

Worked directly with executive leadership to improve onboarding and activation for AI agent workflows.

- Reduced time-to-value for first-time users through clearer mental models and iterative prototyping
 - Established product direction for early-stage AI surfaces through user research synthesis and design principles
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Theoriq

Founding Product Designer – AI & Crypto Agents | 2024 – 2025

Owned the end-to-end product experience for AI agents and crypto-native collectives operating with real assets.

- Designed governable agent workflows balancing autonomy, user control, and trust in high-stakes environments
 - Partnered with CEO and founding team to translate experimental infrastructure into a credible, usable product
 - Established foundational interaction models validated through early adopter feedback and iterative testing
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CurbCutOS

Product Design Lead – SaaS Accessibility | 2023 – 2024

Led transition from consulting-led services to a scalable accessibility SaaS platform.

- Established design system and automated accessibility testing workflows adopted by enterprise customers
 - Reduced manual audit time by 60% through integrated testing and compliance-focused UX design
 - Shaped product direction informed by interviews with accessibility professionals and enterprise compliance teams
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Zalando SE (now Zalando Partner)

Senior Product Designer – Design Systems | 2021 – 2022

Contributed to the first B2B design system supporting multiple marketplace verticals.

- Improved cross-team consistency and development efficiency through reusable component libraries and standards
 - Collaborated with engineering to scale system adoption across internal and partner tooling
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Independent / Studio Work (Selected)

Independent Product Designer | 2016 – Present

Led product and system design engagements for early-stage startups and embedded product teams. Delivered AI-native UX, design systems, and rapid prototypes across SaaS, developer tools, and crypto.

Selected clients: Walmart, Obvious.ai, Coinbase (contract), Zalando, Travelnest, Frequency (Berachain), Graceview.ai, JazzX AI (Microsoft), CurbCutOS, Artscapy, Kerubin.

Education

Apple Developer Academy – UX / UI Design, Naples, Italy

ILAS Design School – Diploma with Honors

Skills & Expertise

Product & Design

- Product strategy in ambiguous environments
- AI-native UX and interaction models

- Developer-facing experiences
- Design systems and component architecture
- Discovery and execution
- Data-informed design decisions
- User research and usability testing

Design Engineering & Technical Fluency

- Design-engineering collaboration
- React/Tailwind prototyping
- LLM workflows and agent systems
- API-aware UX design
- Metrics-informed optimization

Tools & Workflow

- Figma (advanced features, tokens, variants)
- React, Tailwind, Framer Motion
- AI development tools (Cursor, Claude Code)
- LLM tooling and prompt systems

References

Available upon request.

Former managers and partners include senior leaders from Walmart, Coinbase, Voiceflow, Theoriq, Obvious.ai, Zalando, and CurbCutOS.